

SEAN ALEXANDER

CANDIDATE FOR NORTH VANCOUVER CITY COUNCIL

www.seanfornorthvan.ca

Dear Editor,

RE: NORTH VAN COUNCIL MOTION ON METRO SEWAGE PLANT INQUIRY

North Vancouver residents deserve a higher standard of local governance.

On July 6, City Council unanimously passed a late-addition motion demanding a provincial inquiry into the \$3.86 billion Metro Vancouver sewage plant debacle. While I support demanding answers, a motion of such scale should never have been kept off the public agenda until the last second, leaving residents in the dark.

Our local leaders are right to demand transparency from regional bureaucrats. A \$3 billion cost overrun that adds \$590 annually to local household utility bills for the next three decades is a staggering failure. In the private sector, project managers overseeing such a blunder are escorted out of the building. In government, they simply slide the bill under the taxpayer's door.

But true accountability must also apply at home. While regional infrastructure fails, our city faces a deeply human housing crisis. Recent rezonings at 1540 St. Georges Ave. and 215-235 E. 16th St. threaten long-term tenants with displacement.

Working families are squeezed from both sides: facing displacement from rapid development while bearing a 30-year utility tax hike for blunders they didn't make.

If we want a transparent, accountable city hall, the cultural shift toward open communication and proactive agendas must start with us.

SEAN ALEXANDER

City of North Vancouver Resident and Council Candidate

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